

Question:

A 60-year-old woman is brought to the emergency department because of altered mental status for 2 hours. She and her husband were at the grocery store when she suddenly could not remember why she was there or how she got there. She has not had any head trauma. She has a history of depression and migraines. She does not smoke and drinks a glass of wine each night with dinner. She takes fluoxetine daily. She appears distressed and anxious. Her vital signs are within normal limits. She is fully alert and oriented to self and place but not to time. Every few minutes she asks how she got to the emergency department. She is able to follow commands and sustain attention. She recalls 3/3 objects immediately and recalls 0/3 objects at 5 minutes. The remainder of the neurological exam shows no abnormalities. Which of the following is the most likely diagnosis?

Answer Choices:

- A. Transient global amnesia
- B. Depersonalization/derealization disorder
- C. Seizure
- D. Migraine

Reasoning + Answer:

<think> The question is asking for the most likely diagnosis for a 60-year-old woman with altered mental status .

To answer this question , we need to identify the key features of the patient's presentation and history .

The patient has a history of depression and migraines , but her current symptoms are more consistent with a cognitive disorder rather than a psychiatric or neurological condition .

The patient's altered mental status is characterized by confusion and disorientation to time , which is a common feature of transient global amnesia .

The patient's ability to follow commands and sustain attention , as well as her normal neurological exam , makes seizures and migraines less likely .

Depersonalization/derealization disorder is not consistently associated with disorientation to time and confusion .

Therefore , the most likely diagnosis is transient global amnesia . </think><answer> Transient global amnesia </answer>